TOP 5 MOST IMPROVED COLLEGES ARCHITECTURE

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	RANK 2026	RANK 2022
1	DEPARTMENT OF ARCHITECTURE, NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY HAMIRPUR	Hamirpur	6	11
2	BMS SCHOOL OF ARCHITECTURE	Bengaluru	26	37
3	RV COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE	Bengaluru	10	12
4	UNIVERSITY SCHOOL OF ARCHITECTURE & PLANNING	New Delhi	11	13
5	DEPARTMENT OF ARCHITECTURE AND PLANNING, BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MESRA	Ranchi	7	8



says students are trained to deal with the challenging context of hill areas. "Most of the exercises focus on actual fieldwork or live projects. Students learn from real-life sites in Himachal and other hill regions and provide solutions suited to that context," he says.

Like many other professional fields, architecture is also being transformed by digital technologies and AI, and NIT Hamirpur is adapting its curriculum accordingly. Kumar says the department is adopting a hybrid framework, adding that while AI can assist in generating design options and improving efficiency, critical decisions must continue to be guided by human creativity, contextual understanding and professional judgement. The goal is to equip students to work alongside emerging technologies while retaining the analytical and design skills central to the profession. Institute registrar Dr Archana Santosh Nanoty says the architecture department has benefited from the investments in academic and research infrastructure. "The upgraded studios and labs, advanced design software and interdisciplinary research opportunities have fostered an enriching learning environment."

The department's industry-oriented approach is reflected in its 100 per cent placement record over the past three years. Recruiters include leading organisations such as L&T, DLF Ltd, Tata Consulting Engineers and several other specialised architecture, design and infrastructure firms. The department is also encouraging the entrepreneurial spirit among students. Among the notable startups set up by alumni are 'Make My Hut' and 'NORTH', ventures focused on preserving traditional Himalayan building knowledge.

Its alumni network has also expanded significantly, with many of the early graduates now occupying leadership positions in organisations across the US, Singapore, the UAE and other countries. By harnessing its unique Himalayan setting, interdisciplinary strengths and industry connections, the department seeks to produce professionals who are also responsible contributors in a rapidly changing world. ■

GURUSPEAK



"The department offers future-oriented architectural education rooted in Himalayan contexts, sustainability and disaster-resilient design. Practical learning with modern tools make for industry-ready professionals"

PROF. H.M. SURYAWANSHI
Director, NIT Hamirpur

*The college that has shown the highest improvement in rankings between 2022 and 2026